

CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

What is a conditional sentence ?

A conditional sentence is a sentence that has two parts and two actions will be mentioned in it. **The happening of one action will depend on the happening of the other action.** It is also known as **Conditional Clause** or **"If Clause"**.

Example :-

- I will sleep early today if I finish this chapter in an hour. (My sleeping early depends upon my finishing this chapter in an hour. So it is a conditional sentence.)
- There are certain words like **suppose, if, unless, until, provided, as soon as**, etc. which are used in conditional sentences. Look for these words to identify a conditional sentence and then apply the rules mentioned below.

There are three kinds of conditional sentences. Each kind contains a different pair of tenses. Conditional sentences have two parts:

- (a) If Clause
- (b) The Main Clause.

In the sentence—

- If I don't reach the centre on time, I will miss the exam. ("If I don't reach on time" is the **if clause**, and "I will miss the exam" is the **main clause**)
- If it rains, I shall stay at home. ("If it rains" is the **if clause** and "I shall stay at home" is the **main clause**.)

TYPE: I

When if-clause is in the Simple Present Tense

If the verb in the **if Clause** is in the present tense then the **main clause** can be in simple future tense or in simple present tense also.

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple future

Type 1 conditional is used when something is likely to happen if a certain condition is fulfilled. In this conditional, the **if clause** is in the **simple present tense**, and the **main clause** is in the **simple future tense**.

- We will hire you if you agree to our terms and conditions.
- If you work hard, you will become successful in life.
- If there is an emergency, I will call you.
- If you try to find a solution, you will get one.
- If he studies, he will clear the exam.

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple present

This conditional is known as Type Zero Conditional. It is used when an outcome is guaranteed in a certain situation. It is often used to refer to **general truths**. Simple Present Tense is used in both parts of the sentence. In it, the word **"if"** can be replaced by the word **"when"** without any change in the meaning.

Examples :-

- When you apply heat to ice, it melts.
- If it rains, the grass gets wet.
- If you mix blue and yellow, you get green.
- When you don't get enough sleep, you feel tired.

Special Note :- In case of Type 1 Conditionals, we **do not use will/shall or would in the if clause** when the main clause is in the simple future tense.

Probable changes in the above rule

I. Variations of the "MAIN CLAUSE".

- 1) Instead of the **simple future**, we may use **may/might** if it's a **possibility**. **"May"** is a stronger possibility than **"might"**.
 - If the fog gets thicker, the flight might be delayed. (possibility of flight getting canceled)
 - If the sales do not pick up, we might cut down on our staff.
 - If it rains tomorrow, the venues might be changed.

2) Instead of the **simple future**, we may use **can/may**.

- If the boss agrees, you can leave at once. (**possibility**)
- If your work is completed before noon, we may go to watch a movie. (**permission**)

3) Instead of the simple future tense, we may use **must, should, or any other expression of command** if the sentence has a **request or advice**.

- If you wish to avoid a confrontation, you should involve an arbitrator. (**advice**)
- If you want to lose weight, you must eat less. (**opinion**)
- If you want to lose weight, eat less. (**command**)
- If you meet Ram tomorrow, could you ask him to call me? (**request**)

II. Variation of the “IF CLAUSE”

1) Instead of “**If + present simple tense**”, we can have “**If + present continuous**” to show a **present continuous action** or a **future arrangement**.

- If you are waiting for a bus, you should join the queue. (“**are waiting**” is **present continuous**)
- If you are waiting for your dinner, I will ask the waiter to get it for you.

2) Instead of “**If + present simple tense**”, we can have “**If + present perfect**” to show a **completed action**.

- If you have finished dinner, you may ask the waiter for the bill.
- If he has written the letter, I will post it.
- If he has made arrangements for our stay, I will ask him to pick us up from the station.

TYPE : II

When if-clause is in the Simple Past Tense

The verb in the “**If clause**” is in the **Simple Past Tense**; the verb in the **main clause** is in the **conditional tense**.

The past tense in the **if-clause** is not actually a **true past**. Rather it is **unreal past** which indicates unreality.

Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject + would + Verb (1st form)

Examples :-

- If they invited us to their party, we would definitely go.
- If it snowed in July, I would be very surprised.
- If he sold his bike he would not get much money from it.
- If you went to bed earlier, you would not be so tired.

TYPE : III

When if-clause is in the Past Perfect Tense

The verb in the **If clause** is in the **past perfect tense**, the verb in the **Main clause** is **perfect conditional**. It describes situations that did not happen in the past and their hypothetical results or consequences.

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Examples :-

- If I had known his problem I would have helped him. (**It means I didn't know the problem.**)
- If I had been at home I would not have allowed the robbers to enter. (**It means I was not at home**)
- If I had spoken to him on this issue he would have surely helped me. (**It means I didn't speak to him.**)
- If I had known your basic nature before marriage I would never have married you. (**It means I didn't know your basic nature before marriage.**)

Remember these three sentence structures for conditional sentences-

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple future

Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

SPECIAL CASE :-**"Were to"** in the If-Clause

The verb phrase **were to** is sometimes used in conditional sentences when the likely or unlikely result is particularly **unthinkable**. In this case, **were to** is used to place emphasis on this potential outcome.

Sentence Structure: If + subject + were, subject + would + 1st form of Verb

Examples :-

- If I were to be sick, I would miss another day of work.
- If she were to be late again, she would have to have a conference with the manager.
- If the rent were to have been a penny more, they would not have been able to pay it.

As if / as though

We use 'as if/as though' when we want to give an explanation for something which may not be correct.

(i) Simple past tense is used after "as if" or "as though" to give an unreal explanation for a real incident of present or past.

Examples :-

- She acts as if he knew everything.
- He spends money as if he inherited a fortune from his parents.
- They looked at me as if I were a criminal. (We do not use 'was' after 'as if/as though')

(ii) Past perfect tense is used after "as if" or "as though" to indicate a hypothetical or unreal situation that occurred before the situation described in the main clause.

Examples :-

- She looked frightened as if she had seen the ghost.
- He smiled as though he had found a treasure.

Practice Exercise**Spot the Error :-**

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

- Q.1.** (a) If it will rain /(b) tomorrow, we will /(c) stay indoors /(d) no error.
- Q.2.** (a) I would buy /(b) a new car if I /(c) have enough money /(d) no error.
- Q.3.** (a) If you study hard, /(b) you will pass /(c) the exam /(d) no error.
- Q.4.** (a) If I was you, /(b) I would take /(c) the job offer /(d) no error.
- Q.5.** (a) If she had called me /(b) earlier, I would /(c) able to help her /(d) no error.
- Q.6.** (a) I will go to the beach /(b) if the weather /(c) was nice /(d) no error.
- Q.7.** (a) If he will finish /(b) his homework, he can /(c) play video games /(d) no error.
- Q.8.** (a) If I won the lottery, /(b) I had traveled /(c) around the world /(d) no error.
- Q.9.** (a) If they won't hurry, /(b) they will /(c) miss the bus /(d) no error.
- Q.10.** (a) If it snows tonight, /(b) we can build /(c) a snowman tomorrow /(d) no error.
- Q.11.** (a) He walks as if /(b) the Earth belongs /(c) to him /(c) no error.
- Q.12.** (a) If he had worked hard /(b) he had become /(c) an inspector /(d) no error.
- Q.13.** (a) If I had not seen /(b) the car coming, I /(c) might have been killed /(d) no error.
- Q.14.** (a) If you had told me /(b) yesterday i will /(c) helped him /(d) no error.

- Q.15. (a) If I had a bungalow /(b) I would have /(c) give you /(d) no error.
- Q.16. (a) Were Babita a boy/(b) Navya will /(c) marry her /(d) no error.
- Q.17. (a) If he had taken the /(b) earlier train, he /(c) will be here by now /(d) no error.
- Q.18. (a) If I have a million /(b) dollars, I would /(c) buy a yacht /(d) no error.
- Q.19. (a) If I had seen /(b) you, I would have /(c) been stopped the car /(d) no error.
- Q.20. (a) If you heat water /(b) to 100 degrees Celsius, /(c) it boils /(d) no error.
- Q.21. (a) If we leave the mattress in the/(b) sun for some time/(c) all the dampness would vanish./(d) no error
- Q.22. (a) If you are looking for a course worth your money/(b) you will/(c) join Pinnacle online series./(d) no error
- Q.23. (a) Many people would be/(b) out of work if that/(c) factory close down./(d) no error
- Q.24. (a) If she sold her car,/(b) she will not get/(c) much money for it./(d) no error
- Q.25. (a) If they don't arrive/(b) soon we'll leave/(c) without them./(d) no error
- Q.26. (a) Alan is going/(b) to post me/(c) the recipe if he found it./(d) no error
- Q.27. (a) If he's staying/(b) at the party,/(c) I'm leaving./(d) no error
- Q.28. (a) If I had known/(b) you were coming I would/ (c) have ordered food../(d) no error
- Q.29. (a) Had he spoken to me/(b) I will have forgiven/(c) him from the bottom of my heart?/(d) no error
- Q.30. (a) I would lose/(b) my job if I were/(c) late for work./(d) no error
- Q.31. (a) If they are late/(b) I'm going/(c) to be angry./(d) no error
- Q.32. (a) If he fell asleep/(b) while driving,/(c) he will hit his car somewhere./(d) no error
- Q.33. (a) I lost my job/(b) because I were/(c) late for work./(d) no error
- Q.34. (a) We couldn't go/(b) to the concert because we didn't/(c) have enough money./(d) no error
- Q.35. (a) If we have enough/(b) money, we would/(c) go to the concert./(d) no error
- Q.36. (a) The doctor will see/(b) you today only if/(c) it's an emergency./(d) no error
- Q.37. (a) Unless/(b) he revises the whole syllabus/(c) he would not be able to score more than 150./(d) no error
- Q.38. (a) If he called again,/(b) I will call/(c) the police right here./(d) no error
- Q.39. (a) I will wait for you/(b) unless/(c) I don't have an emergency in the hospital./(d) no error
- Q.40. (a) If I was you/(b) I would stop/(c) talking to him./(d) no error
- Q.41. (a) If they had waited for another month,/(b) they would probably get a/(c) better price for their house./(d) no error
- Q.42. (a) It's quite simple really when/(b) it's cold and the temperature/(c) falls, water froze./(d) no error
- Q.43. (a) If he decides to accept/(b) that job, he regretted it/(c) for the rest of his life./(d) no error
- Q.44. (a) If he hadn't been driving so fast,/(b) he would not have killed/(c) the motorcyclist./(d) no error
- Q.45. (a) If he become careful,/(b) he would have spotted/(c) the mistake./(d) no error
- Q.46. (a) If she goes on/(b) passing her exams,/(c) she will soon be qualified to practise as a lawyer./(d) no error

Q.47. (a) If I pay you twice as much,/(b) can you be able/(c) to finish by Tuesday?/(d) no error

Q.48. (a) If only I'd invested/(b) in that company, I will have become/(c) a millionaire by now./ (d) no error

Q.49. (a) Had the parachute opened/(b) on time the accident would/(c) not have happened./ (d) no error

Q.50. (a) If I was you,/(b) I wouldn't/(c) take the risk./ (d) no error

Fill in the Blanks Correctly :-

Q.1. If the company offers me the job, I think I _____ it.

- (a) will take (b) would take (c) would have taken (d) would have took

Q.2. I'm sure she will lend you some money. I would be very surprised if she _____.

- (a) refused (b) refuse (c) will refuse (d) refuses

Q.3. They would be disappointed if we _____.

- (a) did not went (b) did not go (c) does not go (d) would not has gone

Q.4. Would your father be angry if I _____ his bicycle without asking ?

- (a) taken (b) took (c) had taken (d) would have taken

Q.5. My mom has given me this gift and she _____ terribly upset if I lost it.

- (a) will be (b) shall be (c) would be (d) would have been

Q.6. If someone _____ in here with a gun, I'd be very frightened.

- (a) walk (b) walks (c) would walk (d) walked

Q.7. What would happen if you _____ to work tomorrow ?

- (a) do not go (b) did not go (c) will not go (d) would not go

Q.8. I'm sure she _____ if you explain the situation to her.

- (a) will have understood (b) would have understood (c) will understand (d) shall have understood

Q.9. The police _____ him if they had any clue about him.

- (a) will have arrested (b) would have arrested (c) will arrest (d) shall have arrested

Q.10. What will happen if my parachute _____ ?

- (a) does not open (b) do not open (c) will not open (d) had not opened

Q.11. I will be angry if he _____ more mistakes.

- (a) makes (b) make (c) made (d) would have made

Q.12. If I _____ you ten rupees, when will you give it back to me?

- (a) gave (b) give (c) gives (d) had given

Q.13. If you do not like this one, I _____ you another one.

- (a) will bring (b) would bring (c) brings (d) shall bring

Q.14. If we _____ our crops would have been sown on time.

- (a) had proper rains (b) have proper rains (c) had rained (d) had rain

Q.15. If you paint the walls white the room _____ much brighter.

- (a) will be (b) would have been (c) could have been (d) is to be

Q.16. I _____ the roof myself if I had a ladder.

- (a) can repair (b) could repair (c) could have repaired (d) had repaired

Q.17. What _____ if you had heard the fire alarm?

- (a) would you have done (b) can you do (c) will you do (d) you would have done

Q.18. If anyone attacks me, my dog _____ at him.

- (a) will jump (b) jumped (c) is to jump (d) can jump

Q.19. If everybody gives me 100 rupees we _____ enough.

- (a) will have (b) would have (c) have (d) had

Q.20. If you _____ Pinnacle at the right time we would have worked had to make you clear.

- (a) have joined (b) had joined (c) will join (d) would have joined

Answers With Explanation :-

Spot the Error

Sol.1.(a) Replace "will rain" with "rains". We do not use 'will/shall' or 'would' in the if-clause when the main clause is in the Simple Future Tense.

Sol.2.(c) Replace "have" with "had". Simple Past Tense is used in the if-clause in a type 2 conditional sentence.

Sol.3.(d) no error.

Sol.4.(a) Replace "was" with "were". Simple Past Tense is used in the if-clause in a type 2 conditional sentence.

Sol.5.(b) Replace "would" with "would have been". Type 3 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Past perfect, would have + V₃'.

Sol.6.(c) Replace "was" with "is". Simple Present Tense is used in the if-clause in a Type 1 conditional sentence to express the possible or likely outcome.

Sol.7.(a) Replace "will finish" with "finishes". We do not 'will/shall' or 'would' in the if-clause when the main clause is in the Simple Future Tense.

Sol.8.(b) Replace "had traveled" with "would travel". Type 2 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Simple Past, would + first form of verb'.

Sol.9.(a) Replace "won't" with "don't". We do not 'will/shall' or 'would' in the if-clause when the main clause is in the Simple Future Tense.

Sol.10.(d) no error.

Sol.11.(b) Replace "belongs" with "belonged". Simple Past tense is used after "as if" to give an unreal explanation for a real incident.

Sol.12.(b) Replace "had" with "would have". Type 3 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Past perfect, would have + V₃'.

Sol.13.(d) no error.

Sol.14.(b) Replace "will" with "would have". Type 3 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Past perfect, would have + V₃'.

Sol.15.(b) Remove "have" from part (b). Type 2 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Simple Past, would + first form of verb'.

Sol.16.(b) Replace "will" with "would". Type 2 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Simple Past, would + first form of verb'.

Sol.17.(c) Replace "will be" with "would have been". Type 3 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Past perfect, would have + V₃'.

Sol.18.(a) Replace "have" with "had". Type 2 conditional follows the structure: 'If + Simple Past, would + first form of verb'.

Sol.19.(c) Replace "been stopped" with "stopped". This sentence is an example of Type 3 conditional in the active voice as the subject 'I' is the doer of the action.

Sol.20.(d) no error. This sentence is an example of Zero conditional.

Sol.21.(c) Replace "would" with "will".

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

Sol.22.(b) It's a suggestion so use "should" in place of "will".

Sol.23.(c) Replace "close" with "closes"; factory is singular. So, "s/es" will be used with the verb.

Sol.24.(b) With the simple past, "would" is used. Replace "will not" with "would not".

RULE: Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Sol.25.(d) no error.

Sol.26.(c) Replace "found" with "finds". With if clause, simple present is used.

RULE: The verb in the if clause is in the present tense.

Sol.27.(a) Replace "he's staying" with "he stays".

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

Sol.28.(d) no error

Sol.29.(b) Replace "will" with "would".

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

The verb in the main clause is in the simple future. It does not matter which clause comes first.

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple future

Sol.30.(d) It is an imaginary sentence; in imaginary sentences, "were" is used.

Sol.31.(d) no error.

Sol.32.(a) Replace "fell" with "falls". Simple present should be used with an if clause.

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

The verb in the main clause is in the simple future. It does not matter which clause comes first.

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple future

Sol.33.(b) It is not a conditional sentence. It is an assertive sentence simply stating a past fact, so with "I", singular verb "was" is used. Replace "were" with "was".

Sol.34.(d) It's an assertive sentence and not a conditional sentence.

Sol.35.(a) Replace "have" with "had".

RULE: Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Sol.36.(d) no error.

Sol.37.(c) Replace "would" with "will".

"Revises" represent that sentence is in present tense. Thus, use "will".

Sol.38.(a) Replace "called" with "calls". With "if" clause, a simple present is used.

Sol.39.(c) With "unless", "don't" is not used.

Sol.40.(a) Replace "was" with "were"

In imaginary sentences, "were" is used.

Sol.41.(b) Use "would have got".

RULE: Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Sol.42.(c) Replace "froze" with "freezes".

Sol.43.(d) Replace "regretted" with "will regret".

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

The verb in the main clause is in the simple future. It does not matter which clause comes first.

Sentence structure: If + simple present, Simple future

Sol.44.(d) no error.

Sol.45.(a) Replace "become" with "had become".

TG-@freepdfhall

search on TG-@freepdfhall

RULE: Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Sol.46.(d) no error.

Sol.47.(b) Replace "can" with "will".

RULE: The verb in the if Clause is in the present tense.

Sol.48.(b) Replace "will have become" with "would have become".

RULE: Sentence structure: If + Simple past, Subject would + Verb (1st form)

Sentence structure: If + Past Perfect, Subject would + have + Verb (3rd form)

Sol.49.(d) no error.

Sol.50.(a) Replace "was" with "were" as the sentence is imaginary.

Fill in the Blanks

Answer Key :-

1.(a)	2.(d)	3.(b)	4.(b)
5.(c)	6.(d)	7.(a)	8.(c)
9.(b)	10.(a)	11.(a)	12.(b)
13.(a)	14.(a)	15.(a)	16.(c)
17.(a)	18.(a)	19.(a)	20.(b)